GM crops

Genetically modified crops are food and fibre crops that have been modified by gene technology. External genes are inserted into a plant to change or improve its characteristics.

☞ **1** Add the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the notes below.

Potential benefits

- Improved **yields** and r__d__c__d damage from pests, d__s__ __s__s and weeds
- Reduced costs due to less p__st__c__d__ use
- More flexible f__rm__ng operations
- Less c__lt__v__t__ __n means better s__ __l **conservation**
- Reduction in pesticide p__ll__t__ __n

Potential risks

- P__ss__bl__ health effects
- New **allergens** could be cr__ __t__d
- Herbicide/pesticide r__s__st__nc__ may occur __v__r time
- Cross br__ __d__ng could occur with wild or non-GM cr__ps
- B__ __d__v__rs__ty affected as traditional f__ __d sources are lost
- Companies could c__ntr__l whole food crops
- Ethical/philosophical/religious __bj__ct__ __ns, i.e. scientists playing God

2 Match the following phrases.

GM insect-resistant cotton was	are against using GM crops.
Government agencies rigorously	introduced in Australia in 1996.
External genes are inserted	test GM crops for safety.
Organic food producers	into the crop plant.

3 Organic farmers have a special certificate declaring their food free of any additives, chemicals or artificial substances. Why would an organic farmer object to a neighbour growing GM crops? _____

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